

Concept

A serene, low-poly 3D exploration game where the player controls an animal (most likely a cat or fox) through a handcrafted world. The focus is on *relaxation, discovery, and atmosphere* rather than challenge.

The map will be populated by ambient creatures (e.g., butterflies, bees, etc.), and feature varied elements including flowers, trees, vegetation, water areas, and ruins. The goal is to craft a beautiful environment that showcases concepts learned both in class and through independent research.

Visual Style

Cartoon/low-poly aesthetic with soft, harmonious colour palettes. Atmospheric lighting will shift with a day/night cycle. The playable character and some environment assets will be modelled in Blender, keeping a consistent, non-realistic look, but expressive rather than minimal.

Core Features

- Playable animal with smooth movement and animations (walk, run, idle, sit)
- Hand-crafted map with flowers, trees, vegetation, water, ruins, and more
- Ambient creatures (butterflies, bees, birds) populating the environment
- Day/night cycle with dynamic atmospheric lighting
- Ambient soundscape such as wind, water, birdsong, and other environmental sounds to reinforce the peaceful mood
- Keyboard and mouse controls for movement and camera

References and Inspiration

The following games served as the main sources of inspiration for this project: *A Short Hike*¹, for its peaceful world and unhurried pace; *Firewatch*², for the visual approach, particularly forests, atmospheric lighting, and environmental mood; *Alba: A Wildlife Adventure*³, for the idea of interacting with nature and wildlife in a gentle way; and finally, *ABZŮ*⁴, as a reference for exploration-driven gameplay and strong, cohesive art direction.

¹<https://ashorthike.com/>

²<https://www.firewatchgame.com/>

³<https://www.albawildlife.com/>

⁴<https://abzugame.com/>